

CA02

Rajasthan: Awards, Events, Sports, Personalities,

Places

About 4-6 questions inside the ~21-question current affairs block. The facts change every year; the categories never do. Content window here is roughly September 2025 to September 2026, compiled as of September 2026.

This is the 'Rajasthan in the news' chapter — awards won, places listed, matches won, people appointed. RPSC builds four to six questions a paper out of it, and the pattern of what it picks has been the same for a decade: a literary award (usually Sahitya Akademi in Rajasthani), a Rajasthani sportsperson, a new listing or a new first for the state.

Rajasthan in the News (Sept 2025 - Sept 2026)

Awards

- Sahitya Akademi 2025 - Rajasthani: Jitender Kumar Soni
- Padma 2026 - Taga Ram Bheel, Gafruddin Mewati Jogi
- Republic Day tableau 3rd (Popular Choice)
- GI tag: Jodhpuri Mozri

People

- Rajeshwar Singh - State Election Commissioner
- Justice Sanjay K. Agarwal - CJ, Rajasthan HC (recommended)
- Justice Ranjana P. Desai - UCC committee
- Diya Kumari - Budget 2026-27

Places & listings

- 5 Ramsar sites (Menar, Khichan, Siliserh added 2025)
- 5 notified tiger reserves; Kumbhalgarh proposed
- Renamings: Abu Raj, Kamvan, Yajnpur
- Six eco-cities

Events & firsts

- Exercise Agni Varsha, Pokhran
- Vibrant Villages Ph-II, 184 villages
- First state with rare-earth exploration licence
- Pachpadra refinery dedicated (Balotra)

Sports

- Arundhati Choudhary (Kota)
- CWG 2026 boxing GOLD
- Yashvir Singh - javelin bronze
- Sth Khelo India University Games, Jaipur
- Tour de Thar, Bikaner

What this chapter is, and how RPSC actually asks it

Everything here happened in the last eighteen months or so. There is no textbook for it. RPSC's paper-setters build these questions from state press releases, Rajasthan Sujas and newspaper headlines — which is why Rajasthan current affairs is rated the hardest bucket in the paper every single year. But hard does not mean unpredictable. The categories repeat exactly.

- A literary award question — most often Sahitya Akademi in the Rajasthani language.
- A sports question with at least one Rajasthani athlete in it.
- A 'new listing' question — Ramsar site, tiger reserve, GI tag, heritage status.
- An appointment or a personality — who holds which state post now.
- A 'first for Rajasthan' — first state to do X, first policy of its kind.
- So study by category, not by date: learn the Ramsar five as a set, the award winners as a table.
- Everything here is stated as of September 2026 — refresh the volatile items in November 2026.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH shows two hard patterns: the Sahitya Akademi award in Rajasthani was asked in RAS Pre 2018 AND again in 2023, and every single paper carries a sports block of 4-6 questions containing at least one Rajasthani athlete. Treat both as guaranteed.

Sahitya Akademi and the literary awards — the documented repeat

Start with the Sahitya Akademi. It is the national academy of letters, and it gives an annual award in 24 Indian languages — Rajasthani is one of them. Each award is Rs 1,00,000 with an engraved copper plaque. The 2025 awards were announced on 16 March 2026 and presented on 31 March 2026 in New Delhi. This is the single most examinable item in the chapter.

The Rajasthani award — learn the last decade as a table

Sahitya Akademi Award in Rajasthani, 2015-2025

Year	Author	Work
2025	Jitender Kumar Soni	Bharkhama (short stories)
2024	Mukut Maniraj	Gaon Ar Amma
2023	Gaje Singh Rajpurohit	Palakati Preet
2022	Kamal Ranga	Alekhun Amba
2021	Meethesh Nirmohi	Mugtee
2020	Bhanwar Singh Samaur	Sanskriti ri Sanatana Deeth
2019	Ramswaroop Kisan	Barik Baat
2018	Rajesh Kumar Vyas	Kavita Devai Deeth
2017	Neeraj Daiya	Bina Hasalpai
2016	Bulaki Sharma	Murdjat Ar Dujee Kahaniyan
2015	Madhu Acharya 'Ashawadi'	Gawaad

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in RAS Pre 2023 — the Sahitya Akademi award in the Rajasthani language. For 2026, the answer to know cold is Jitender Kumar Soni for 'Bharkhama', a short-story collection (award for 2025, announced March 2026).

YAAD RAKHO

Remember the last four in order, backwards from the newest: So-Ma-Ra-Ra — Soni (2025), Maniraj (2024), Rajpurohit (2023), Ranga (2022). And remember the genre with the name: Bharkhama = kahaniyan (short stories), not poetry.

Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025 — announced 16 March 2026

Language	Awardee	Work / form
Hindi	Mamta Kalia	Jeete Jee Allahabad (memoir)
English	Navtej Sarna	Crimson Spring (novel)
Rajasthani	Jitender Kumar Soni	Bharkhama (short stories)
Urdu	Pritpal Singh Betab	Safar Jaari Hai
Punjabi	Jinder	Safety Kit
Sanskrit	Sadhu Bhadreshdas	-

Now the state layer. Rajasthani as a language has its own state academy — the Rajasthani Bhasha, Sahitya evam Sanskriti Akademi at Bikaner. Its top honour is the Suryamal Mishran Shikhar Award, named after the 19th-century poet-historian of Bundi, carrying Rs 71,000. It has run since 1985, and the first recipient was Shakti Dan Kaviya. Do not mix this state award up with the national Sahitya Akademi award — RPSC likes exactly this kind of near-miss pair.

National vs state literary honour

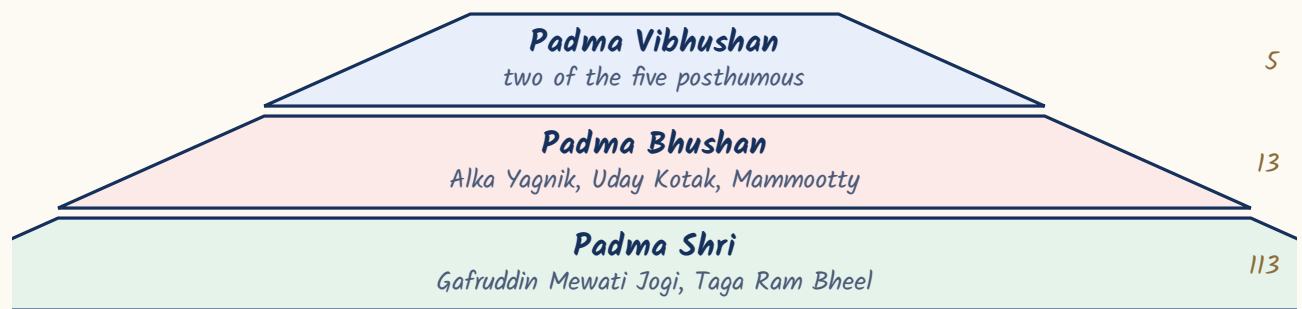
Sahitya Akademi Award	Suryamal Mishran Shikhar Award
Sahitya Akademi, New Delhi (national academy)	Rajasthani Bhasha, Sahitya evam Sanskriti Akademi, Bikaner
24 languages, Rajasthani one of them	Rajasthani language only
Rs 1,00,000 + plaque	Rs 71,000
2025 award: Jitender Kumar Soni	Instituted 1985; first awardee Shakti Dan Kaviya

- Rajasthan Ratna is the state's highest civilian honour, on the Bharat Ratna model — Rs 1 lakh, shawl and citation.
- Its recipients include Allah Jilai Bai, Kanhaiyalal Sethia, Vijaydan Detha, Komal Kothari and Pt. Vishwa Mohan Bhatt.
- Most Rajasthan Ratna awards have been posthumous — a favourite statement-question trick.

Padma Awards 2026 and the Rajasthanis in the list

Padma awards are announced on the eve of Republic Day and conferred at Rashtrapati Bhavan later in the year. Three grades, in descending order: Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, Padma Shri. On 25 January 2026 the government announced 131 awards — 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and the rest Padma Shri. 54 of the awardees were described as 'unsung heroes'. Learn the total, the split and the Rajasthan names.

Padma Awards 2026 – 131 in all, announced 25 Jan 2026



Padma Vibhushan 2026 — all five

Name	Field	Note
Dharmendra	Art	Posthumous
V.S. Achuthanandan	Public Affairs	Posthumous
K.T. Thomas	Public Affairs	-
N. Rajam	Art	Violinist
P. Narayanan	Literature and Education	-

- Padma Shri 2026 from Rajasthan: Gafruddin Mewati Jogi (Art) and Taga Ram Bheel (Art) — both in Art.
- Padma Bhushan 2026 names worth knowing: Alka Yagnik (Art), Mammootty (Art), Uday Kotak (Trade and Industry), Vijay Amritraj (Sports).
- Mammootty's field is Art, not Sports — the classic 'which pair is NOT correctly matched' bait.
- Two of the five Padma Vibhushan awards in 2026 were posthumous.

State honours, the tableau, GI tags and heritage

Rajasthan's Republic Day tableau is asked almost as often as the Padma list, because it packages a theme and a rank in one line. In 2026 the tableau was titled 'Desert's Golden Touch' (Registan ka Sunahra Sparsh), it was themed on the Usta art of Bikaner — the gold-embossed camel-hide craft — and it took third place in the Popular Choice category, announced 30 January 2026.

- 44th India International Trade Fair (November 2025, New Delhi): Rajasthan won GOLD in the Partner State category.
- Outlook Traveller Awards 2025: Udaipur named 'Best Wedding Destination'.
- PMFBY Kharif 2025: Rajasthan ranked FIRST in India in farmer enrolment.
- National Tobacco Control Programme 2024-25: best-performance award to Rajasthan.
- GI tag July 2026: Jodhpuri Mozri, the roughly 200-year-old footwear craft; Kota Doria, Bagru and Sanganeri prints were tagged much earlier.
- The Walled City of Jaipur was inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List in 2019 — not 2026.

CURRENT LINK

Live issue as of September 2026: UNESCO has asked Rajasthan for a conservation report on the Walled City of Jaipur by December 2026. If a status change is reported before the exam, it will make a question — check this in November 2026.

Places in the news — Ramsar sites, tiger reserves and renamed places

A Ramsar site is a wetland of international importance designated under the Ramsar Convention of 1971. India's tally has been climbing fast, and Rajasthan jumped from two sites to five in a single year. This is the highest-probability 'new listing' question in the chapter.

Ramsar sites of Rajasthan



Keoladeo 1981, Sambhar 1990, Khichan and Siliserh 2025; Menar is the fifth

Rajasthan's FIVE Ramsar sites (as of September 2026)

Site	District	Designated
Keoladeo Ghana National Park	Bharatpur	1981
Sambhar Lake	Jaipur and Nagaur	1990
Menar wetland	Udaipur	2025
Khichan	Phalodi	2025
Siliserh Lake	Alwar	2025

- Khichan is the Demoiselle crane (Kurjan) village — thousands winter there every year.
- Menar is called the 'Bird Village' — its listing came from community-led conservation.
- Menar and Khichan were designated on World Environment Day, June 2025, taking India's tally to 91 — then the highest in Asia.
- Sambhar Lake is India's largest inland saline lake; it lies across TWO districts, Jaipur and Nagaur.
- India's 99th Ramsar site: Shekha Lake, Aligarh (April 2026). The 100th: Jay Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary, Ballia, UP (5 June 2026).

YAAD RAKHO

Five sites, remember them as two old and three new: KE-SA (Keoladeo 1981, Sambhar 1990) then ME-KHI-SI (Menar, Khichan, Siliserh — all 2025). Old ones are national-park and salt-lake; new ones are bird wetlands.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2016 and 2023 both asked about Keoladeo and Sambhar as Ramsar sites. With three new additions in 2025 the natural 2026 question is the total — the answer is five, and Siliserh (Alwar) is the one candidates forget.

Now the tiger reserves. Rajasthan has FIVE notified tiger reserves. A sixth is proposed but not yet notified, and that gap is exactly where RPSC sets its trap. Learn the five with their districts, and learn the sixth as 'proposed'.

Tiger reserves – five notified, one only proposed



Dots at each reserve's district town; Kumbhalgarh is proposed, not notified

Notified tiger reserves of Rajasthan

Tiger reserve	District(s)	Notified
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	1973-74 (Project Tiger's first batch)
Sariska	Alwar	1978-79
Mukundra Hills	Kota, Chittorgarh, Jhalawar, Bundi	2013
Ramgarh Vishdhari	Bundi	2022
Dholpur-Karauli	Dholpur and Karauli	2023

TRAP

Kumbhalgarh is only PROPOSED, not notified. The proposal joins Kumbhalgarh with Todgarh-Raoli, about 1,397 sq km across Rajsamand, Udaipur, Pali, Ajmer and Sirohi; the NTCA gave in-principle approval in August 2023 and it was still pending as of September 2026. If an option says Rajasthan has six tiger reserves, it is wrong. Two more reserve facts to carry: Sariska completed 18 years of tiger reintroduction in 2026, and the first inter-state translocation involving Rajasthan was planned from Pench (MP) to Ramgarh Vishdhari, Bundi.

Renamings of 27 February 2026

Three places renamed

Old name	New name
Mount Abu	Abu Raj
Kaman	Kamvan
Jahazpur	Yajnpur

TRAP

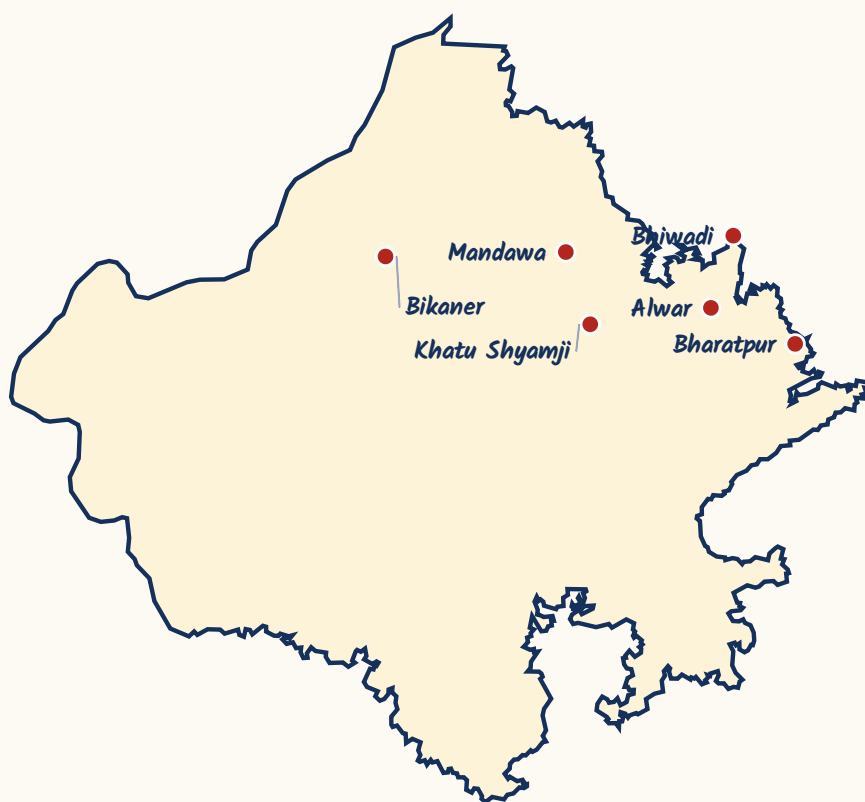
Do not cross-match the renamings. Mount Abu became ABU RAJ, not Kamvan. Kaman became Kamvan. Jahazpur became Yajnpur. RPSC's standard trick here is to swap two of the three in a 'NOT correctly matched' question.

Conservation and environment stories from the state

The Great Indian Bustard (Godawan) is Rajasthan's state bird and India's most closely watched breeding programme. As of March 2026 the captive population had reached 73 birds. The headline event was 'Operation Egg Transfer' — a fertilised egg was carried 770 km from the Sam centre in Jaisalmer to Kutch in Gujarat in 19 hours, and the chick hatched there after a gap of a decade.

- Careful: the chick was born in KUTCH, Gujarat, not in Rajasthan — the egg travelled out, the hatching happened outside. Statement questions are built on exactly this.
- February 2026: statewide ban on felling of the KHEJRI, the state tree, after an 11-day Bishnoi community agitation.
- The khejri ban sits in a long tradition — Khejarli 1730, Amrita Devi and the Bishnoi sacrifice for the same tree.
- October 2025: six eco-cities approved — Mandawa, Khatu Shyamji, Bhiwadi, Alwar, Bikaner and Bharatpur. Pushkar is NOT one of them.
- 'Developed Rajasthan @2047' sets a \$4.3 trillion economy target for the state.

The six eco-cities approved in October 2025



All six lie in the north and east – Pushkar is NOT one of them

CURRENT LINK

Watch this one: on 30 December 2025 the Supreme Court suspended the 100-metre height criterion used to classify the Aravallis and ordered a high-level expert committee covering Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi-NCR. The committee's definition, whenever it lands, changes what counts as protected Aravalli land in Rajasthan. Status as of September 2026 — pending.

Sports — the Rajasthani athlete question

Every RAS paper carries a sports block, and at least one question in it is about a Rajasthani. For 2026 the name to know before any other is Arundhati Choudhary.

- **ARUNDHATI CHOUDHARY** of KOTA won **GOLD** in women's 70 kg **BOXING** at the Commonwealth Games 2026.
- She beat England's Chantelle Reid by a 5-0 unanimous decision.
- Yashvir Singh won **BRONZE** in the men's javelin throw at the same Games; Neeraj Chopra took silver — an India 1-2 finish.
- Chief Minister Bhajanlal Sharma felicitated the state's CWG 2026 medallists with cash awards.
- Uma Chaudhary (CISF) won gold in javelin at the World Police and Fire Games 2025, Birmingham.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH cluster 84: a sports block of 4-6 questions appears in every paper and always includes at least one Rajasthan athlete. Arundhati Choudhary — Kota, boxing, 70 kg, gold, CWG 2026 — is the highest-probability single name in this whole chapter after the Sahitya Akademi winner.

Events in the state, 2025

Event	Where	Detail
5th Khelo India University Games 2025	Opened at Sawai Mansingh Stadium, Jaipur	Across 7 Rajasthan cities; 4,448 athletes from 222 universities
Tour de Thar 2025 (23 Nov 2025)	Bikaner	India's FIRST desert cycling rally
Cognivera International Polo Cup 2025	Jaipur Polo Ground	India beat Argentina 10-9

- State sports honours to know by name: the Maharana Pratap Award for players and the Guru Vashishtha Award for coaches.
- A 5 per cent GST on the horse trade was levied for the first time at the PUSHKAR Fair in 2025 — not at the Nagaur cattle fair.

Personalities and appointments

Appointment questions are pure recall, so keep them in one table and revise the table, not the news stories. Positions below are as of September 2026. Note the link to your polity notes: the State Election Commissioner is a state constitutional post under Article 243K, and the UCC drafting committee is headed by a retired Supreme Court judge.

Who holds what in Rajasthan (as of September 2026)

Person	Position	When
Bhajanlal Sharma	Chief Minister	-
Diya Kumari	Deputy Chief Minister and Finance Minister	Presented Budget 2026-27 on 11 Feb 2026
Rajeshwar Singh (retd IAS)	State Election Commissioner	September 2025, succeeding Madhukar Gupta
Justice Sanjay K. Agarwal	Recommended as Chief Justice, Rajasthan High Court	Collegium recommendation, 31 Aug 2026
Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai	Chairperson, Rajasthan UCC drafting committee	June 2026

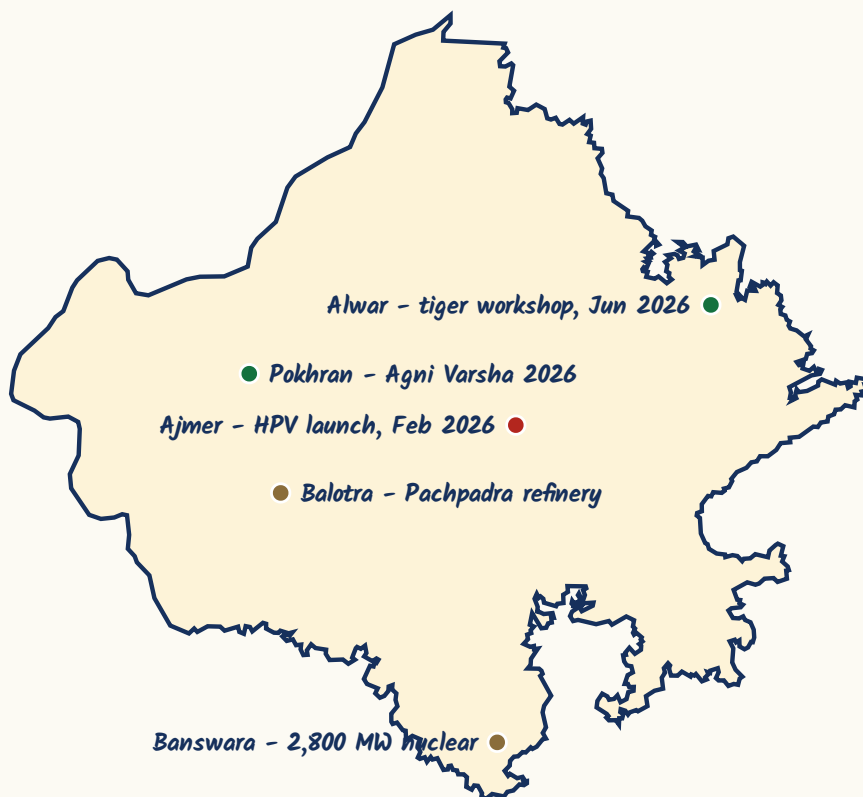
CURRENT LINK

Volatile as of September 2026: Justice Sanjay K. Agarwal was only at the recommendation stage for Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court on 31 August 2026. Re-verify whether the warrant of appointment was issued before you sit the paper in December 2026.

Events, summits, projects and firsts for the state

Rajasthan hosted or launched a long list of national events in this window. Group them by 'what kind of event' and the district — RPSC's matching questions pair the event with the place.

Match the event to its place



RPSC pairs the event with the district - learn them as pairs

National events held in / launched from Rajasthan

Event	Place	Date
Rajasthan DigiFest with TiE Global Summit 2026	JECC, Jaipur	4-6 Jan 2026
Exercise AGNI VARSHA 2026 (Army, integrated desert warfare)	Pokhran (Jaisalmer district)	27 Feb 2026
National HPV vaccination campaign launched by the PM	Ajmer	28 Feb 2026
Vibrant Villages Programme Phase-II launched by Amit Shah	Border districts	26 May 2026

Event	Place	Date
National workshop on tiger rehabilitation	Alwar	28 Jun 2026

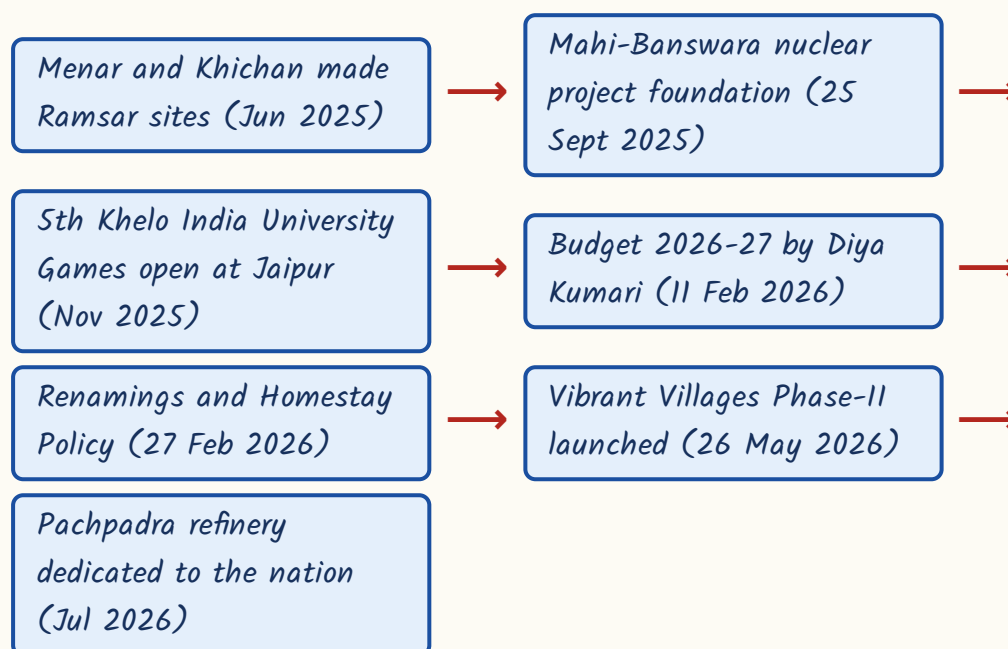
- *Vibrant Villages Phase-II covers 184 border villages of Rajasthan at about Rs 3 crore per village per year.*
- *District split of those villages: Sri Ganganagar 68, Bikaner 46, Barmer 36, Jaisalmer 30, Phalodi 4.*
- *Mahi-Banswara Rajasthan Atomic Power Project (2,800 MW): foundation stone by PM Modi at Banswara, 25 September 2025.*
- *HPCL's Pachpadra refinery was dedicated to the nation in July 2026.*
- *Bandikui-Jaipur greenfield expressway and projects worth about Rs 17,000 crore launched from Ajmer, 28 February 2026.*
- *Budget 2026-27 headline numbers: about Rs 6.11 lakh crore, 1 lakh jobs, 42,000 km of roads, Rs 6,800 crore for tap water, Rs 3,000 crore for solar parks.*
- *Nai Kiran Nasha Mukti Yojana launched 29 March 2026 — de-addiction and rehabilitation, aligned to Nasha Mukh Bharat Abhiyaan.*

TRAP

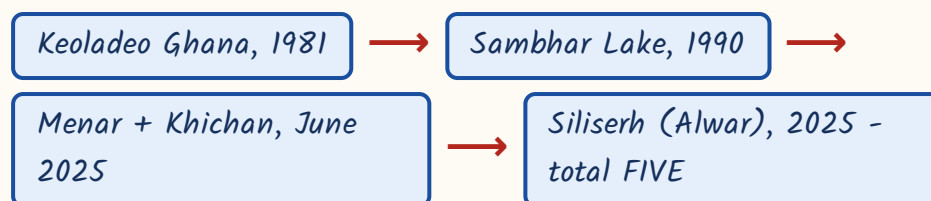
The Pachpadra refinery is in BALOTRA district, not Barmer. Balotra was carved out of Barmer in 2023 and survived the December 2024 district reorganisation. Old study material still says Barmer — in a 2026 paper, Balotra is the answer.

- July 2026: Rajasthan became the FIRST state to operationalise a rare-earth-element exploration licence — Balotra-Jodhpur block, 207.63 sq km.
- First state to adopt the Centre's PRAGATI-style project review platform, named 'Raj-Unnati' (projects worth about Rs 1,943 crore across five departments).
- Rajasthan's FIRST Semiconductor Policy 2026 (cabinet, 21 Jan 2026) — Jodhpur-Pali-Marwar corridor as priority zone, capital subsidy up to 60 per cent under the India Semiconductor Mission.
- PM-KUSUM: Rajasthan crossed 2,000 MW, Jodhpur DISCOM leading, about 2.83 lakh farmers benefited.
- Homestay Policy 2026 (27 Feb 2026): room limit raised from 5 to 8 and the owner-residency condition removed.
- Industrial Park Promotion Policy 2026 works through the Raj Nivesh single-window investment portal.
- February 2026 also brought two administrative decisions: the two-child norm for panchayat and municipal elections was abolished, and the Revenue Intelligence and Economic Crime Directorate (RRIED) was created.

The 2025-26 Rajasthan timeline in the order RPSC asks it



How Rajasthan's Ramsar count grew



REVISION RECAP

1. Sahitya Akademi 2025, Rajasthani: Jitender Kumar Soni, 'Bharkhama', short stories — announced 16 Mar 2026, presented 31 Mar 2026, 24 languages, Rs 1 lakh each.
2. Previous Rajasthani winners, newest first: Mukut Maniraj (2024), Gaje Singh Rajpurohit (2023), Kamal Ranga (2022), Meethesh Nirmohi (2021).
3. Suryamal Mishran Shikhar Award = Rajasthani Bhasha, Sahitya evam Sanskriti Akademi, Bikaner; Rs 71,000; since 1985; first awardee Shakti Dan Kaviya.
4. Rajasthan Ratna = state's highest civilian honour; recipients include Allah Jilai Bai, Kanhaiyalal Sethia, Vijaydan Detha, Komal Kothari, Vishwa Mohan Bhatt.
5. Padma 2026: 131 awards on 25 Jan 2026 — 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, rest Shri, 54 'unsung heroes'.
6. Padma Shri 2026 from Rajasthan: Gafruddin Mewati Jogi and Taga Ram Bheel, both in Art.
7. Republic Day 2026 tableau: 'Desert's Golden Touch', theme Usta art of Bikaner, third in Popular Choice.
8. Five Ramsar sites: Keoladeo 1981, Sambhar 1990, Menar 2025, Khichan 2025, Siliserh (Alwar) 2025.
9. Khichan = Demoiselle cranes; Menar = Bird Village; Sambhar straddles Jaipur and Nagaur.
10. India's 99th Ramsar site Shekha Lake (Aligarh, Apr 2026); 100th Jay Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Ballia, 5 Jun 2026).
11. Five notified tiger reserves — Ranthambore, Sariska, Mukundra Hills, Ramgarh Vishdhari, Dholpur-Karauli. Kumbhalgarh only proposed.
12. Renamed 27 Feb 2026: Mount Abu to Abu Raj, Kaman to Kamvan, Jahazpur to Yajnpur.
13. GIB captive population 73 (Mar 2026); Operation Egg Transfer — Sam (Jaisalmer) to Kutch, 770 km in 19 hours, chick hatched in Gujarat.
14. Khejri felling banned statewide, Feb 2026, after an 11-day Bishnoi agitation.
15. Arundhati Choudhary, Kota — gold, women's 70 kg boxing, CWG 2026, beat Chantelle Reid 5-0; Yashvir Singh javelin bronze behind Neeraj Chopra's silver.
16. 5th Khelo India University Games opened at SMS Stadium Jaipur — 7 cities, 4,448 athletes, 222 universities.

17. Tour de Thar 2025 (Bikaner) = India's first desert cycling rally; Cognivera Polo Cup — India beat Argentina 10-9 at Jaipur.
18. Rajeshwar Singh = State Election Commissioner (Sept 2025); Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai heads the UCC drafting committee (Jun 2026).
19. Firsts: rare-earth exploration licence (Balotra-Jodhpur, Jul 2026), Raj-Unnati PRAGATI-style platform, Semiconductor Policy 2026.
20. Pachpadra refinery is in BALOTRA district; Exercise Agni Varsha 2026 was at Pokhran, Jaisalmer district.